

Taking India Global

Invest India's Nivruti Rai loves taking on challenges. Her tenacity will come in handy as she looks to bring in more foreign investments

BY SURABHI

WHAT ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF?

Don't fear anyone, take more risks

YOUR MANTRA FOR NAVIGATING CHALLENGES?

Professionally, know what you love doing, apply what you love doing to your job, market what you are doing, build a network and leverage that network



PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA

NIVRUTI RAI

57, MD & CEO, Invest India



"I AM A FIGHTER," declares Nivruti Rai, MD and CEO of Invest India. If a challenge can be personified as a bull, then "I just hold the bull by the horns," Rai says.

It's been over a year since she has assumed her role as the head of Invest India, the national investment promotion and facilitation agency under the Department of Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, and change is clearly visible.

The former Intel India country head makes a comeback to the BT Most Powerful Women in Business list this year after 2022, as she leads Invest India in its next phase, in which it is aiming to bring \$1 trillion in foreign direct investment (FDI) over the next 10 years. "I am in a journey called Invest India 2.0," she says. That involves setting out a global footprint with offices in places like Singapore and the UAE to engage with foreign investors. In FY24, the agency facilitated commitments upwards of \$1.27 billion.

She is proud of the diversity at Invest India, with a nearly 50:50 balance of men and women. That and Rai's tenacity should hold the agency in good stead, as it plays a more central role in facilitating investments. **BT**

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